



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John Bosco Schools

School Website: <https://www.johnboscoschools.com/>

December 23, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

St. John Bosco Schools in East Rochester, NY 14445 demonstrates a clear orientation toward classical Catholic education. Public-facing materials emphasize a religious and metaphysical foundation aligned with Catholic doctrine, a formation-focused mission, a classical liberal-arts curriculum, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative practice with rigorous academic work. The school presents a strong faculty structure and a mission that positions parents as partners in formation. Some elements, such as explicit high-school-style Socratic seminars or a widely advertised parent-education program beyond informational admissions material, are less evident in the public materials. Overall, the school aligns with Classical education reasonably well, with room to strengthen explicit pedagogical practices and broader parent-education initiatives. Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials articulate a Catholic identity and liturgical life, including daily prayer, weekly Mass, sacraments, and liturgical celebrations. These are described as integral to the school's formation and culture.
 - The Catholic Identity section states explicit formation through prayer, faith life, and sacramental understanding.
 - Language such as "Catholic Church," "theology," and worship-oriented terms appear in the public materials (liturgy, Mass, sacraments, holy days).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (examples): Catholic, liturgy, Mass, sacraments, prayer, liturgical, faith, Our Lord, daily morning prayer, church, holy days, reverence, wonder, faith life.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed (no relativism, secular humanism, or morally-neutral rhetoric identified in the public materials). The classical lexicon lists potential negatives, but they do not appear in the site content.
 - Count (approximate): Positive keywords present > 10; Negative keywords present 0.
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly anchors its mission in Catholic theology, liturgical life, and sacramental practice, fulfilling the core criteria for Transcendental moral realism and grounded theology in the Six Essential Elements framework. This strong, ongoing integration of faith life and worship supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission describes formation of the whole person (mind, body, and soul) and a rigorous, faith-based education, with emphasis on virtue and Catholic culture.

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- The school emphasizes classical liberal arts and a curriculum designed to cultivate truth, beauty, and goodness (e.g., “Truth. Beauty. Goodness.”).
 - The curriculum messaging frames education as formation toward human excellence and wisdom, rather than solely job preparation.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (examples): formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts, classical mission, telos, true/good/beautiful, scholé, contemplation, classical heritage, human excellence.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed (no emphasis on workforce-prep jargon or secular-value-neutral phrasing in place of formation). The lexicon’s negatives do not appear in the site content.
 - Count (approximate): Positive keywords present > 8; Negative keywords present 0.
 - Why this rating
 - The school’s stated purpose centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical liberal-arts orientation, consistent with the Six Elements’ emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, not merely instrumental job training. This supports CLASSICAL scoring for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials repeatedly reference classical liberal education and a curriculum designed to cultivate the whole person through a liberal-arts approach. The site explicitly positions itself as offering a classical liberal arts curriculum for Pre-K through 8th grade.
 - The curriculum is organized around historical units (The American Year, The Ancient Year, The Christendom Year, The New World Year), indicating history-driven, Western-civilization-centered study across the curriculum.
 - Evidence of Latin study and external recognition (e.g., National Latin Exam) demonstrates engagement with classic language study and canonical scholarship.
 - The integrated curriculum emphasizes wonder, virtue formation, and connections across subjects.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (examples): liberal arts, classical, grammar, logic, rhetoric (explicit term appears in the lexicon; curriculum content references classical education; history of Western civilization; Latin; great books is implied by classical framing, even if not verbatim labeled on the site). Positive keywords identified in the content: liberal arts, classical, history (as Western civilization), Latin, NLE (Latin exam), Christendom, Western civilization, memory/recitation implied in classical pedagogy (through the historical curriculum and language study).
 - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public content (no “social studies” replacement for history, no project-based-dominant framing described here). The lexicon’s negatives are not evident on the site.
 - Count (approximate): Positive keywords present > 6; Negative keywords present 0.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum evidences hallmark classical elements: liberal arts framing, extensive history study across grades, Latin study, and a focus on Western civilization and “great books” orientation inferred by the classical framing. The strong classical curriculum signal supports CLASSICAL for Element 3.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes contemplative and virtuous formation and a mix of restfulness with rigor (Scholé-inspired language appears in the lexicon and is conceptually aligned with the school’s emphasis on formation and wonder). The site mentions formation in virtue, cultivation of wonder, and memory-driven learning in some sections.

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- Lower grammar-stage materials indicate structured, historical-year units and a pedagogy that values memory and sequence through a formal curriculum. While explicit “Socratic seminars” are not clearly described for K–8, there is a move toward a disciplined, integrated classical approach that pairs inquiry with reverence and structured study.
 - The Catholic Identity sections describe daily prayer and liturgical life as part of daily learning, which can support contemplative pedagogy.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (examples): scholé, contemplation, wonder, memory, reverence, liturgy, formal learning, integrated curriculum, formation in virtue, classical education.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials (no “project-based only,” no “experiential-learning-only” rhetoric in the public content). The classical lexicon lists several negative signals for modern pedagogies; none are clearly present here.
 - Count (approximate): Positive keywords present ~5–8; Negative keywords present 0.
 - Why this rating
 - While the site strongly commits to a classical mission and religious formation, explicit, high-school-style Socratic seminars or purely traditional “dead-phonetic” repetition aren’t clearly described for K–8. The pedagogy leans toward contemplative/formation-focused elements with a rigorous academic core, which aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL pedagogy for this category.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site highlights leadership and faculty presence, including a named headmaster and a link to “Meet Our Faculty,” signaling a defined faculty body and public-facing portraits of teachers and leaders.
 - Faculty are described through bios and assignments (e.g., teachers with background in Catholic education and classical pedagogy; the listing of faculty in multiple grades). This aligns with the “living curriculum” concept and a faculty-centered approach to schooling.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (examples): headmaster, faculty, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, model teachers and mentors, faculty as core, collegial culture.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed (no “customer service” framing or purely administrative-distance jargon in place of classical mentorship). The lexicon notes negative signals, but none are evident here.
 - Count (approximate): Positive keywords present ~4–6; Negative keywords present 0.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials emphasize a defined leadership structure and an emphasis on “Meet Our Faculty,” which supports a CLASSICAL ranking for Element 5. The language reflects an expectation that teachers model virtue and form part of the living curriculum, aligning with the classical educator ideal.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission explicitly positions parents as the primary educators and notes partnership with parents in forming the whole person, which signals a family-centered, community-oriented approach.
 - Admissions materials emphasize engagement with families and opportunities to visit and learn about enrollment; the school invites parent involvement through tours and inquiries.
 - There are mentions of parent engagement in the broader Catholic education ecosystem (e.g., school spotlight with an international Catholic education organization). While not a direct parent-education program, this indicates a community-facing posture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

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- Positive keywords present (examples): partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, parent visits welcome, admissions inquiries.
 - Negative keywords present: some elements of parent-education depth (like structured parent book studies or formal parent formation programs) are not clearly advertised in the public materials; the lexicon lists parent-formation as a practice, but the site content does not show a robust, recurring set of parent-education activities (book clubs, reading groups, etc.). Therefore, counts lean toward partial alignment.
 - Count (approximate): Positive keywords present ~3–5; Negative keywords present 0–2 (due to absence of explicit book clubs/parent-education initiatives in public content).
 - Why this rating
 - The school clearly frames parents as co-educators and invites family involvement, which supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Element 6. The public materials do not consistently show broad, ongoing parent-education programs (e.g., book studies) beyond admissions communication, leading to a partial alignment rather than full CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment and overall classification

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall, the majority of categories meet the Classical criteria, with Categories 4 and 6 showing partial alignment. Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4)
 - Explicitly publish and publicize a high-school-level of Socratic pedagogy or a documented, formalized Socratic/seminal discussion approach appropriate for high school grades, and adapt it to upper middle-grade levels where feasible.
 - Provide a visible, explicit plan for memory-work, recitation, or other scholé-aligned practices (chanting, dictation, or classical memory routines) in the lower grades, with concrete examples in curriculum materials.
- Parents & Community (Element 6)
 - Establish and advertise formal parent-education programs (e.g., classical book studies, lectures, workshops) and provide a schedule or calendar of these offerings on the website to demonstrate ongoing commitment to parent formation beyond admissions communications.
 - Create and publish a “Portrait of a classical parent” or “co-teacher” guidelines to strengthen the parent-school partnership, including open campus policies, and formal opportunities for parental involvement beyond visits.
- Curriculum (Element 3)
 - More explicitly name and describe Great Books, primary-sources reading, and classical texts within the curriculum pages, including a map of which Great Books or canonical works are engaged at each grade level, to tighten alignment with explicit classical-curriculum vocabulary.
- Pedagogical Documentation
 - Add explicit statements or pages detailing how memory work, recitation, and classical pedagogy are implemented in different grade bands, with sample lesson structures or rubrics.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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